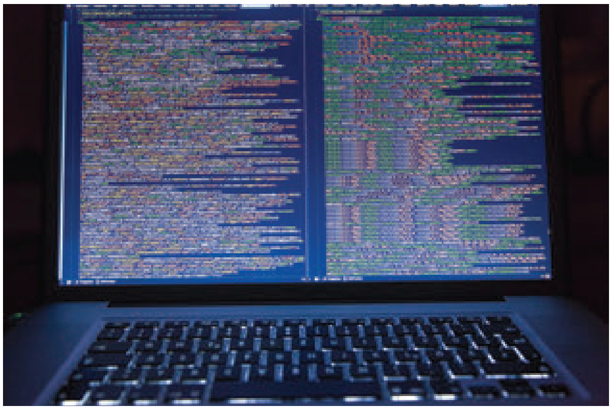

Users can scan and reorder songs while having access to playlist controls, facilitating multitasking and engagement. Additionally, lyrics and related content sit side-by-side with player controls, creating a more immersive experience. The optimization of the YouTube Music app for large screens allows users to interact with their music in a more visual and engaging way. The app's ability to respond to any screen size across tablets and foldable phones ensures that users can enjoy a consistent and optimal experience across all their devices.

C. Calm

Calm, a popular meditation and relaxation app, has also updated its interface to better suit larger screens. The app now features vertical navigation, reducing the need for excessive scrolling. This design is more ergonomic for larger screens, which tend to be held by the side as opposed to smaller phones typically held from the bottom. When used on a foldable phone, the app shifts seamlessly when transitioning from a folded to an unfolded state, demonstrating the effective use of app continuity. By reducing the need for scrolling and ensuring smooth transitions between different states, Calm has successfully optimized its app for foldable phones and larger screens, making relaxation and meditation sessions more enjoyable and intuitive for users.

Practical steps to develop apps for folding phones with Android

The advent of folding phones presents a unique opportunity for app developers to reframe the user experience in more dynamic and immersive ways. Android, being an open and flexible platform, has been quick to provide tools and libraries to support this innovative form factor. This section will provide an overview of these resources, a guide on their usage, and tips for testing and debugging apps optimized for folding phones.

Overview of tools and libraries provided

One of the key libraries provided by Android for developing apps for foldable phones is the Jetpack WindowManager. This library offers a common API surface for various WindowManager features, making it easier to support new device form factors on both old and new platform versions.

The Jetpack WindowManager library includes the FoldingFeature class, which describes a fold in a flexible display or a hinge between two physical display panels. This class provides access to important information about the device, such as the current posture of the device (FLAT or HALF_OPENED), whether a FoldingFeature separates the window into multiple physical areas, the occlusion mode, the orientation of the FoldingFeature, and the boundaries of the device feature.

Always be prepared for the unexpected. The foldable form factor is still relatively new, and users may interact with your devices in ways you hadn't anticipated. Keep an open mind, be ready to iterate on your designs, and use user feedback to continuously improve your app.

Future of app development for folding phones and big screens

The development of applications for folding phones and large screens is still a relatively new area in the software industry, but it is already showing signs of being an exciting and rapidly evolving field. As folding phones and large screens become more prevalent, the future of app development is likely to be heavily influenced by these devices and their unique capabilities.